Battles with Britain

The American colonies began to have a strained relationship with Britain and frustration grew as time passed. For the British, the colonies were established to assist the homeland but the American colonies had their own interests to protect. In 1651, a new law was passed that prohibited the American colonies from trading with the Netherlands, France, Spain and their respective colonies. The idea was to restrict American trade so only Britain would benefit from the colonization. This began a series of acts known as the Navigation Acts.

The population of the colonies in North America kept on growing during the 18th century. Historians estimate it to have been around 300,000 by the latter part of the 17th century and more than a million in 1760. The population doubled in the next two decades. Finally, immigrants from Northern Ireland, Scotland, Germany and other countries began arriving in the colonies in search of a new life.